

Details for AI Evals Course

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To: jbdamask@gmail.com

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Hi John D,

Welcome to AI Evals For Engineers & PMs! Hamel and I are super excited to kick off this cohort. This email will serve as an onboarding guide. A link to a Google Doc with this email's contents can be found [here](#).

Important Links

- **Course reader.** The course reader is available here: <https://docsend.com/v/rcdy7/evals-course-reader-fall-25>. It will stay updated throughout the cohort. Treat it as internal to the course; please do not redistribute. We highly recommend reading the course reader
- **Discord.** Please join our Discord at this [link](#). Once you sign up, it will ask you to submit an application with your maven email address. It may take up to 72 hours for us to verify your application - please be patient! If you do not see access by then, email Alan with your Discord handle and your Maven email at alan@parlance-labs.com. The Discord community has channels for each lesson and homework, and will be your main forum for discussion and ongoing support. The lessons are organized into weeks, for example the discord channel for week 1 is “**week-1-lessons**”
- **Maven portal.** All lesson pages, office hour links, and recordings live in the Maven course portal: <https://maven.com/parlance-labs/evals/2025-3/home>.

Make sure you can log in with the same email you used for enrollment. If you have any issues gaining access, email **support@maven.com**.

- **Delphi.** This cohort we are trying an AI assistant that you can ask you evals questions to. See the “Delphi” section below to learn more. You can access the assistant at: <https://www.delphi.ai/hamel>
- **Optional exercises.** Our course has optional written and coding exercises. Written exercises are at the end of each chapter in the course reader. Coding exercises are hosted on GitHub: <https://github.com/ai-evals-course/recipe-chatbot>. They are optional but strongly recommended if you want hands-on practice applying what you learn. We will provide links to the specific coding exercises to do for the week in the lesson sections in Maven. Links to exercise solutions are on the README in the form of video walkthroughs.

Course Details

- **Flipped classroom format.** Lessons are pre-recorded and released at the beginning of each week. Our live time together is reserved for interactive problem-solving, not lectures—so you can get the most out of the course. Feel free to ask any questions in office hours—about lectures, about homeworks, about any problems you are trying to solve in your projects, etc.
 - There are **12 office hours with Hamel and me** across the four weeks, scheduled across time zones.
 - Additional TA office hours and vendor workshops will be announced as they are confirmed.
 - **All live sessions (office hours, bonus lessons) are recorded and usually posted on Maven within forty-eight hours.**

- **Bonus Mini Course:** As a bonus for all students, Isaac Flath is teaching a 5+ hour mini-course on how to tackle the optional homework assignments using AI assistance. Drawn from his popular [AI coding course](#), this series is designed for both developers and PMs. You will learn how to use AI agents as a partner to apply the course concepts, explore new topics, and complete the homework effectively. It's a course on AI Evals, and we want you to use AI to learn it. You'll see these on the calendar.
- **Schedule.** Each week on Maven follows the same structure: it begins with a "Start Here" section that outlines objectives and readings for the week, followed by the week's lessons, a "Links and FAQ" section, and then a section for office hours. See the screenshot below for how week 1 works:



AI Evals For Engineers & PMs

Home



 Home

 People

CHANNELS

 admins

 announcements

 general

 intros

 questions

 submissions 

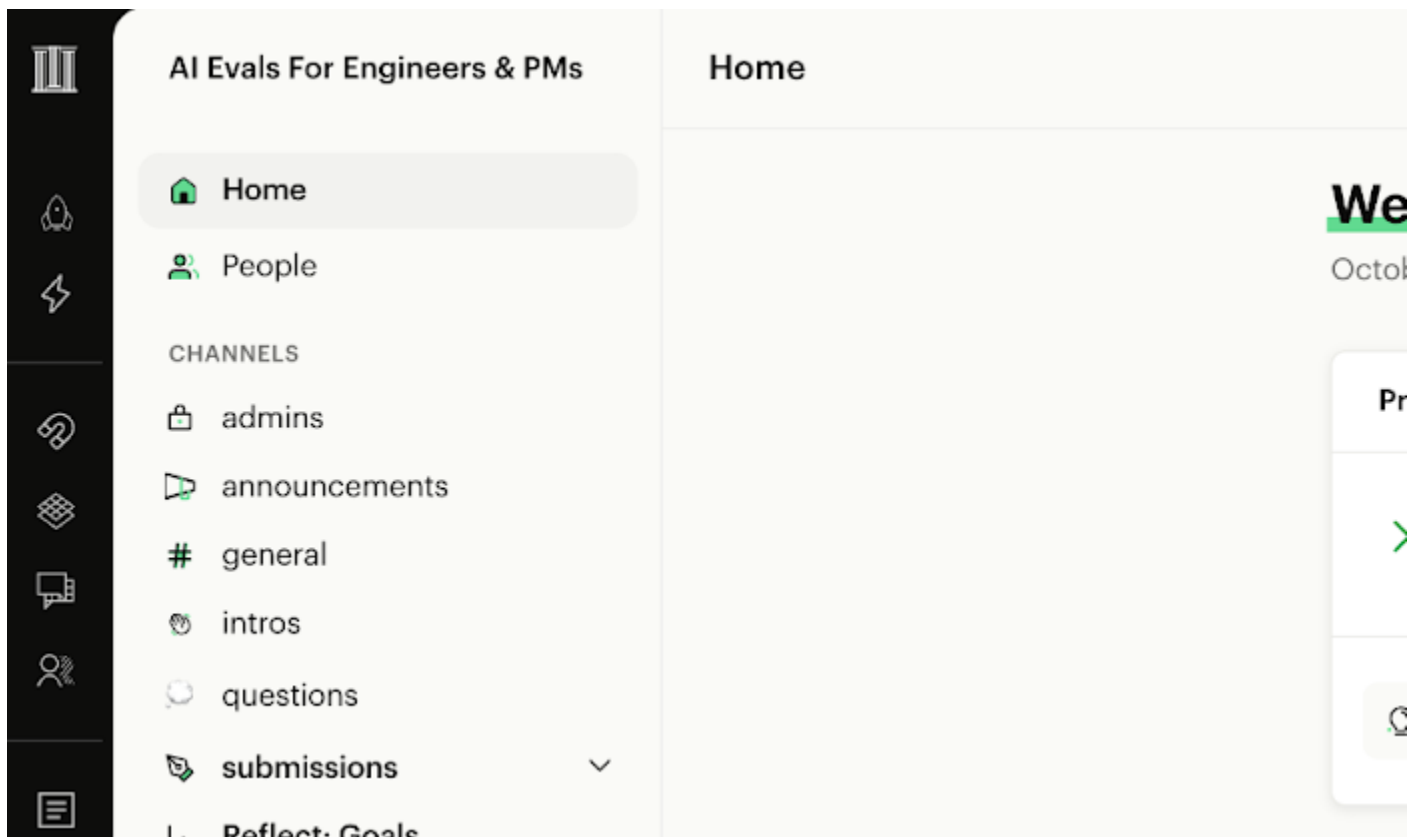
 Reflect: Goals

 Reflect: Takeaways

 Reflect: Wrap-up

You will see most of the lessons with a lock sign on them, like in the screenshot above. The week's content becomes available on Mondays at 12:00 AM Pacific Time. This means you can always start the new material at the beginning of the week, with office hours running later in the week to reinforce and extend what you've learned.

- **Subscribing to the course calendar.** You can subscribe to the course calendar directly from the Maven portal. This will put the office hours and any other live workshops on your calendar. See the screenshot below or follow [this guide](#) for how to subscribe to the course calendar.



Delphi

Every student in this cohort will receive ten months of unlimited access to Delphi, our AI eval assistant trained on the complete body of our work. Invitations will be sent to your Maven email later this week; if you do not receive one by October 10,

contact Alan at alan@parlance-labs.com. Do not email me or Hamel—your email will probably get lost.

Once you are logged in, you can use Delphi at <https://www.delphi.ai/hamel>. Think of Delphi as a *complement* to Discord and office hours: you can ask it any question about evals and get an instant response, whether you are debugging code, clarifying a concept, or looking for examples. The interface looks like the screenshot attached below.

⚠ This is an experimental teaching tool. If you want to be assured of a correct answer, ask Shreya and Hamel who are registered for the Discord yet, do so here: <https://discord.com/invite/3d9KPUGw3x> (you will have to support them)



Hamel

ML Engineer

Chat

Description

This is an AI assistant designed to help you learn about ML. You can find more information at <https://maven.com/parlance-labs/>

View more ▾

Suggested Questions

⚡ What are LLM Evals?

⚡ Should I use "ready-to-use"?

⚡ What parts of evals can be e

⚡ How should I version and m

⚡ | Ask Hamel Husain a ques

Keep in mind that Delphi is fully experimental. It may not sound like us, and its answers can be vague or even incorrect. To get the most value out of Delphi, keep these guidelines in mind:

- **Be specific.** Provide context and details about your situation rather than asking broad questions. For example:
 - Instead of: *“How do I evaluate my legal RAG system?”*
 - Try: *“I’m building a RAG system that retrieves case law relevant to motions under California’s Racial Justice Act. The model generates candidate passages for attorneys to cite in their filings. My concern is whether the retrieval is surfacing precedent that is both on-point and still good law. What evaluation methods should I use to measure retrieval quality and detect when the system cites outdated or overturned cases?”*
- **Ask follow-ups.** If an answer feels vague or incomplete, push further and ask clarifying questions. For example:
 - Instead of stopping at: *“Delphi says: you can use precision and recall to evaluate retrieval.”*
 - Follow up with: *“Can you show me how to calculate precision and recall for my dataset of 200 Racial Justice Act motions, where each motion can have multiple relevant cases? How would you define a ‘relevant’ case in this context, and what baseline numbers should I expect?”*
- **Rephrase your question.** Try different phrasings of the same question. For example:
 - Less effective: *“When should I use pairwise comparisons?”*
 - More effective: *“When should I use pairwise comparisons and when should I not? Can you give me a concrete example? Which approach should I start with?”*

- **Cross-check.** Use Delphi alongside Discord discussions and office hours, not in place of them! We are looking at all our data (aka your queries), but since this is the first time we are using Delphi, we do not know how good it will be.

If you notice an incorrect or unhelpful answer, let us know in Discord so we can improve it for everyone.

Other Stuff

- **Lifetime access and retakes.** You will have *lifetime* access to all course recordings, slides, and materials, as well as to our Discord community. In addition, students in this October 2025 cohort (Cohort 3) have unlimited retake flexibility. That means if we open a new cohort in the future, you do not need to register again. Instead, simply email Alan (alan@parlance-labs.com) and say you would like to join that new cohort, mentioning that you were part of Cohort 3. Alan will confirm your prior enrollment and add you to the roster for the later cohort.
- **Technical support.** Contact support@maven.com for enrollment or payment issues, and contact alan@parlance-labs.com for Discord or Delphi access.

That's everything you need to get started. Please post in Discord if you have any questions. It's going to be an awesome course! Get excited!

Best,

Shreya and Hamel